The lighthouse keeper watched the harbour empty itself of boats, one patient hull at a time, until only the old ferry remained. She had read every book the mainland sent her, and the margins of each were crowded with questions nobody had answered. Tonight the lamp turned above her with its familiar complaint, a sound she had long ago stopped hearing. The weather report promised a storm that would arrive before midnight and leave behind the kind of silence that makes a person reconsider their choices. The lighthouse keeper watched the harbour empty itself of boats, one patient hull at a time, until only the old ferry remained. She had read every book the mainland sent her, and the margins of each were crowded with questions nobody had answered. Tonight the lamp turned above her with its familiar complaint, a sound she had long ago stopped hearing. The weather report promised a storm that would arrive before midnight and leave behind the kind of silence that makes a person reconsider their choices.